

7 Ways to Care for your Printer

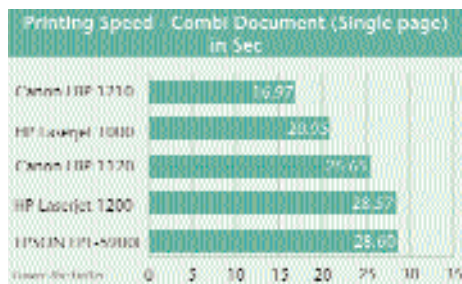
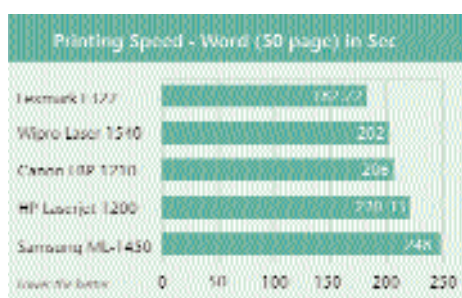


- Select the proper location to place your laser printer. A properly ventilated area is recommended. Select a place where temperature and humidity do not change frequently. Try to avoid areas with heavy dust buildup.
- Position the printer on a sturdy and level surface. Allow sufficient space around the printer for air flow.
- While cleaning your printer, always use a lightly dampened cloth to clean the outside of the printer. To clean the inside use a dry, lint-free cloth. This will ensure that no liquid enters the inner parts of the printer. Most manufacturers provide useful cleaning information on their manuals—always refer to them.
- Use papers manufactured specifically for your printer and also select the correct paper type for your print job.
- Keep your printer up-to-date by downloading the latest drivers and patches from the manufacturer's Web site. This helps because

most manufacturers provide driver updates for their units and these include patches that add fonts or rectify incompatibilities.

■ If debris is the primary cause of failures, toner is the primary cause of debris. All toner cartridges release a small amount of toner into the machine. This is why it's important to clean the machine when you change the cartridge. It is also important that the density control of the machine be properly set to prevent the machine from pulling too much toner into itself. We all like dark prints, but if your print settings are too dark, it could be detrimental to the life of the cartridge in the long run.

■ Don't pile documents or miscellaneous objects on top of your printer, as they could cause damage. Your printer could overheat and this could result in malfunctioning and even a reduction in the printer's life.



seconds to print the image file—ideal for you if your daily work revolves around printing a large number of image-heavy documents. Another worthy mention here is the HP Laserjet 1000, which logged an impressive time of 29.93 seconds.

The Lexmark E322 struggled in this test, posting a below-average score of 148.41

seconds (2 minutes, 28 seconds). The Wipro Laser 1540 was also sluggish, taking 140 seconds (2 minutes, 20 seconds) to complete the test.

Our next speed test involved printing a text document with approximately 30 per cent text coverage. The Lexmark E322

did well here, firing out 50 pages in just a little above 3 minutes (182.72 seconds). Following closely was the Wipro Laser 1540 which took approximately 20 seconds more to get the job done (202 seconds) and the Canon LBP 1210 (206 seconds). The slowest printer in this test was the Canon LBP 1120—it clocked 355 seconds (5 minutes, 55 seconds) to print the 50 pages. Look elsewhere if your daily work involves printing documents in huge numbers.

Our next test was the Combi document test. Here we recorded the time taken to print one page of a PDF document consisting of text and graphics. The Lexmark E322, the fastest in the previous test, was ironically the slowest performer here, taking 300.67 seconds (5 minutes) to print the document. The one printer that performed really well in this test was the Canon LBP 1210. This printer was able to print the Combi document in a speedy 16.97 seconds—if your print jobs generally involve large quantities of text-heavy documents, this printer fits the bill very well.



The Lexmark E322 is ideal for printing documents that contain text and images such as a Web page

Decision Maker				
	Monochrome Imaging		General-purpose document printing	
Look for	A printer that features sharp printing quality for images, preferably one with a resolution of 600 dpi or more and a large print buffer		A printer that exhibits fast printing speed and has a large-capacity paper feed tray. A printer with a resolution of at least 600 dpi should be sufficient for these applications	
The models	Price-conscious	Performance	Price-conscious	Performance
	Wipro Laser 1540, Lexmark E210	Canon LBP 1210	Wipro Laser 1540, HP Laserjet 1000	HP Laserjet 1200, Samsung ML-1450
Price range	Rs 13,000 to Rs 16,000	Rs 21,000 to Rs 22,000	Rs 13,000 to Rs 15,500	Rs 20,500 to Rs 21,500

Quality: In this test we printed a TIFF image file at 600 dpi and checked the image for clarity in reproducing details in the photograph. The difference in image quality was not as stark as it would have been if they were colour printers. However, some printers still managed to stand out here with discernible variations in image quality.

In terms of overall image quality and clarity, most of the printers did quite well. Printers like the Canon LBP 1210 and the HP Laserjet 1200 performed well in reproducing clarity in monochrome images as well as text—there was no smudging or loss of contrast in the printed page. The only